Team 2 Research Document

Research Assignments -

Team Member	Research Topic
Jastiasia:	Target Audience such as young Adults, Housing Affordability, Salaries, Rent vs. Buying, Grants
Christiney:	Newport News such as Community, Lifestyle, Jobs, Housing Market, Current Housing Hub
Cat:	Other Cities' Housing Hubs & First-Time Homebuyer Websites
Andy :	Marketing & Social Media in how to reach the younger crowd

PROTOTYPE WEBSITE (updated)

Newport News Housing Hub

Questions to ask while researching

- What did you learn?
- What works well?
- What doesn't work well?
- How could Newport News improve?
- What ideas could we borrow?

Jastiasia -

Target Audience Research

Research Goal

Understand young adults' housing needs, challenges, and behaviors.

Sources

- Virginia Housing
- U.S. Census Bureau
- Newport News Department of Housing & Neighborhood Services

Key Findings

- Financial education is needed for a lot of young adult
- Affordability is a big concern
- It's intimidating when it comes to buying a house
- Paying rent and other bills makes it hard to save enough money for a down payment.
- Young adults are more likely to learn about housing programs through social media than from traditional websites or flyers.

Statistics / Facts

- The average salary for 18-25 is 33,000 to 44,000
- Housing costs have been going up way quicker than most people's wages in communities.
-

Challenges Young Adults Face

- Thinking they need a 20% down payment when many programs require much less
- Student debt or other financial problems
- Limited knowledge on homebuying process

Opportunities for Newport News

- Down payment assistance grants (First-Time Home Buyers Assistance Program can provide 25,000 in assistance

- Creating simple educational content explaining grants, budgeting, and the homebuying process.
- Partner with local colleges to reach graduates or recent graduates before they begin searching for a home.

Ideas Inspired by Research

- Create Instagram reels or tiktoks on home buying tips
- Host free First time homebuyers workshops in local areas and colleges .
- Create a can I afford a home calculator on the Housing Hub website.
- Offering step by step home buying checklist.

Biggest Takeaway

Christiney Ponton

Newport News Research

Research Goal

Learn about Newport News, its Housing Hub, community, and what attracts residents.

Sources

- https://www.yelp.com/search?find_desc=Fun+Things+To+Do+For+Adults&find_loc=Newport+News%2C+VA
- https://www.nnva.gov/193/Apply-for-a-Job
- https://nnrha.net

Key Findings

- VIP Entertainment - Peninsula Town Center, Circuit Social, Painting with a Twist, Victory Rover, Tilt Studio, and the Noland Trail. Parks and recreational facilities.
- Great job opportunities: shipbuilding, government, manufacturing, and healthcare.
- Housing Hub has various information that is pretty helpful for those who wish to learn about Newport News affordable housing.
- The community in Newport News enjoys the robust job market and

Strengths of Newport News

- There are various recreational activities that are great for adults aged 18-35 throughout the Newport News area.
- These local Newport News businesses are easily accessible to local housing areas.
- Newport News is a great place for young people 18 - 35 to work and find a home for a fast commute.
- Newport News is investing resources into housing for low to moderate income families and individuals.

Weaknesses / Opportunities

- The housing hub is confusing to navigate, poorly designed and needs more accessibility features since a large number of users will be elderly and disabled.
- Lack of advertising
-

Ideas Inspired by Research

- Update the housing hub, there is info from 2022 - 2024 that needs to be fact checked and updated.
- The city can attract younger people with the jobs in the city and offer affordable housing with a focus on faster commute times.
- The hub should have local attractions and bios from people that live in the city to show the Newport News lifestyle and communities.
-

Biggest Takeaway

Newport News should advertise and collaborate with their local business, along with advertising the government jobs opportunities that can only be found in the city. This will build a stronger community and attract new people to live there.

Cat Greene

Other Cities' Housing Hubs & First-Time Homebuyer Websites

Research Goal

Research other cities to identify best practices and innovative ideas that Newport News could adopt.

Cities Researched

- Virginia Beach
- Norfolk
- Portsmouth
- Suffolk
- Chesapeake
- San Diego
- Charlotte
- Other: _____

Sources

- https://housing.virginiabeach.gov/housing-resources?
- Apply For | Suffolk, VA
- Home - City of Charlotte
- https://www.norfolk.gov/5297/Housing-Resources?
- https://www.prha.org/
- Official San Diego Housing Commission (SDHC) Website
- https://www.cityofchesapeake.net/

San Diego Housing Commission offers -

- Housing Opportunities menu
- Rental assistance programs
- Path to Success initiative
- Affordable rentals
- Tenant protections
- First-Time Homebuyer Program
- Affordable homes for sale
- Loan servicing
- Resources for homeowners
- Resources for lenders and escrow companies
- Accessory Dwelling Unit (ADU) information
- Affordable housing preservation

What Stood Out

- Everything is grouped under one Housing Oppor section.
- The navigation is organized by what the user is trying to accomplish instead of making them search a lot of departments to get to one place
- It serves renters, homeowners, developers, and lenders all right there

Opportunities for Newport News

- Create one Housing Hub instead of spreading information across multiple pages.
- Organize information by user needs (Rent, Buy, Own, Improve) instead of by government department
- Include resources for all stages of housing including the rent to ownership prep stage

VA Beach Offers -

- Housing & Neighborhood Preservation website
- Affordable rental information
- Housing Resource Center
- Homeless services
- Financial services
- Family housing
- Fair Housing resources
- Home rehabilitation
- Landlord partnerships

What Stood Out

- The website has strong visual sections with large icons and banners.
- Housing resources are easy to locate.
- There is a dedicated Housing Resource Center.

Areas for Improvement

- Homeownership information is difficult to find.
- Most resources focus on renters or housing assistance rather than first-time buyers.
- Could benefit from a dedicated First-Time Homebuyer section.

Portsmouth offers -

- Property Management
- Housing Choice Voucher Program
- Housing applications
- Public housing information

What Stood Out

- Focuses primarily on rental assistance and housing vouchers.

Areas for Improvement

- No obvious Homebuyer Hub.
- Limited info for people looking to purchase a home.
- Navigation is focused on existing housing assistance.

Suffolk offers -

- Housing-related information spread throughout city departments.
- Zoning
- Permits
- Planning

What Stood Out

- Housing information is difficult to locate.
- Everything is housed within one large city website.

Areas for Improvement

- No dedicated Housing Hub.
- Too many navigation tabs.
- Users have to know exactly what they're searching for.

Opportunities for Newport News

- Keep housing information central
- Reduce the number of clicks required to find info

Charlotte, NC offers

- Affordable Housing
- Emergency Housing Assistance

- Homebuyer Assistance
- Housing Counseling
- Financial Education
- Home Rehabilitation Programs
- Emergency Repair Program
- Safe Home Program
- Asthma Home Repair Program
- Lead-Safe Program
- Housing Dashboard
- Housing Trust Fund
- Affordable Rental Opportunities
- Housing Code Violation Reporting
- Emergency Rent & Utility Assistance
- Resources for Homeowners and Renters

What Stood Out

- Information is organized into large, easy-to-read sections.
- Important services are visible immediately.
- Navi is simple and purposful
- Housing information is grouped together instead of scattered throughout the website.
- Resources are written in understandable language/layout
- The website serves people throughout the entire housing journey.

Why Charlotte Works Well

- Large buttons and headings.
- Clean layout.
- Easy to find assistance.
- Organized by user needs instead of government departments.
- Less overwhelming than many government websites.

Opportunities for Newport News

- Simplify navigation.
- Use larger buttons and clearer categories.
- Create one big bold housing page that includes buying, renting, repairing, and financial assistance.
- Reduce unnecessary navigation tabs.

Things Successful Cities Hubs Did Well

- Make housing info the main focus.
- Offer both the renter and homeowner resources.
- Provide financial assistance info
- Include homebuyer edu.
- Organize content by user needs.
- Use large headings and easy navigation.

Problems I saw

- Too many navigation tabs.
- Small text.
- Information scattered across places
- Homebuyer resources aren't visually available
- Many websites feel outdated and overwhelming with too many links close together
- Does not appeal to the minds of younger folk.

Andy

Marketing & Social Media Research

Research Goal

Learn how to effectively market housing resources to younger adults.

Sources

- City of Newport News, VA - Government | Facebook
- City of Newport News (@cityofnn) • Instagram photos and videos
- Newport News, VA - Official Website | Official Website
- Newport News Redevelopment & Housing Authority – Creating Affordable Housing and Opportunities for Self-sufficiency

Key Findings

- The Newport News Gov site has a section for property information, which goes into details about their real estate assessor (and contact information). The property information section offers plenty of subcategories for Authorization, Property

Assessment, Rehabilitation, etc. In addition, there is information for Tax rates in NN, Assessment Searching, and a Tax Calculator.
- Multiple Social Media sites (Instagram and Facebook). On these social sites, they post about events and important news from the Hampton Roads area.
- The social media posts are about their community events. The most recent one is the Citizen Public Works Academy. However, when scrolling through I haven't seen much about promoting their housing market.
- The Newport News Redevelopment & Housing website has programs (some of which are closed currently) and other information that poses affordable housing for lower and moderate income families. This site is possibly the Housing Hub, based on the information provided in the Team Problem Scope.

Effective Marketing Strategies

- More information on social media about their housing market and its fairness within the VA state laws and regulations. Is it affordable? What new programs are opened up for people to sign up?
- Updates on the events going on or any new attractions in the area.
- Since the target market for this project are the younger generations (Millennials and gen z), maybe focusing on good hangout spots, attractions (theme parks or concert venues) or restaurants would be a good starting point.

Social Media Trends

- Family-friendly Community Events
- Job/Workshop Opportunities
- Important News, Curfews, and Voting

Ideas Newport News Could Use

- Updating their official housing website (Newport News Redevelopment & Housing Authority – Creating Affordable Housing and Opportunities for Self-sufficiency)
- The website is formatted in a way that might make it harder to access for people within certain age groups
- Post more frequent updates on their social media sites or make a new social media account, like Tiktok account since it has more audiences for the age range they want to reach than Facebook and Instagram.
- Highlight more things that people in their 20s-40s can do within the Newport News area.

Biggest Takeaway

My biggest takeaway is that Newport News is behind and needs to do a lot of updates on their websites, so that people can know what is available for affordable housing. Also, most of the recent events have been for the youth/families and not many events catered towards specifically

gen z and millennials. The website is not reliable for the disabled due to its confusing layout and coloring.

Team Discussion Notes

Common Things We Noticed (If any)

- The Housing hub needs a complete rework.
- Lack of exposure and advertisement.
- Accessibility issues with the hub.
- Missing programs (First time homebuyers program)

Interesting Statistics

- Average salary 18k
- Housing higher than yearly pay
- Newport News housing average is higher than income (235k median home price)
- 92% satisfaction rating for aid distribution.
- Top 10 Military city.

Biggest Problems We Identified

- Housing hub
- Lack of social media presence
- No info on community and local attractions
- Lack of advertisement for job opportunities and fast commute
- Good info not on the hub itself.

Opportunities for Newport News

- Creating first time homebuy workshops in local areas.
-
-
-

Ideas We Want to Explore Further

- Attract more military families in age range.
-
-
-
-

Final Verdict (After interview)

What surprised us the most?

What do we think is the biggest opportunity for Newport News?

Based on our research, what direction should our solution go?

Parking Lot

Ideas that don't fit yet, but we don't want to forget.

-
-
-

Interview Questions
Digging/Follow-up Questions:

- Can you give me an example?
- Can you say more about that?
- How did that make you feel?
- Why?

Best Practices:

1. **All:** Introduce yourself and thank your business partner for coming
2. **One person:** Start (on time) by asking your first question, Pick an easy one to get them started.
3. **Share note taking:** Have a plan for who will be taking notes**.** Divide this responsibility up so that you all have a chance to ask questions.
4. **All:** Close (on time) by thanking your business partner for the opportunity.
5. **Tip: "**You are presenting even when you're not presenting." - *Leticia Tuset, Teamship Alumna.*
6. *Try not to ask questions you can easily find on the internet. (avoid shut down questions yes/no) keep it openended.*

Interview plan:
1. Cat
2. Christiney
3. Andy (outro)
4. Jastasia (Introduce last to have better flow)

Possible Intro

"Good evening, everybody! My name is Jastasia, and I'll be leading us through today's interview. First off, we just want to thank you for taking the time to meet with us, we really appreciate you being here. We're excited to hear more about your experiences, learn about the work y'all do, and get your perspective on the Housing Hub. We have a few questions, so we'll go ahead and jump right in

"

Reminders:
Take notes (make sure to keep phones on silent)

We have roughly 6.5 (7.5) mins each, set a timer on device to ensure we are all on track with the interview for the sake of ourselves and the other team.

Make sure to introduce yourself, the college you're representing, and ask your business partner how he is doing!!

Transition phrase:

"Now that I've discussed _housing needs__, I'll turn it over to [Cat], who will discuss more details with you about the housing hub's_structure_."

"To build on these findings, I'll turn it over to [Christiney], who will discuss _Newport News's community and attractions_."

"I'll now hand it over to [Andy] to discuss the city's use of social media__."

Interview Questions

Andy's Questions:

1. What would you say the current struggle of running the Newport News Housing social media is?
2. Would you say Newport News' social media does a good job for advertising to younger generations (Gen Z/Millennials)? - might be scrapped - Always room for improvement
3. How are you different from other housing market businesses?
4. [redacted]
7. There is only facebook and instagram, do you think you guys would like to have an additional social media platform to promote to a bigger audience? - Bring this up to team
8. Is social media a priority for you/the business? - Yes by Default

[redacted]

Christiney's questions:

1. What would make a younger person choose to live in the city opposed to others?
2. What do you believe are some of the reasons as to why younger people are choosing to live in cities other than Newport News? : Do you believe the issue is coming from the lack of attractions in the city, or some other obstacle?

3. Newport News is known as one of the best military cities in the US and has great colleges.
   What are some ways that the city currently uses this strength to connect with military personnel, veterans, and students?
4. How in depth would you like to see this strength be used in attracting young veterans and people in the military to live in the city. : Would having a section focused on the military in the hub be a path the city is interested in?
5. You stated earlier that you wanted to create incentives to make younger people stay, can you expand on that: how would these incentives include the city's connections with the military and colleges? (Student housing)
6. What are some misconceptions about the city of Newport News?
7. What role do you think local business and community organizations could play in attracting new residents?
8. What would you consider successful engagement on the housing hub from members of the community?

Cat's questions

How large is your scope regarding the housing hub, should it be primarily focused on young homebuyers, or should it touch on other aspects such as renters, buyers, builders, etc.
What does a housing hub look like to you?
What are the most common questions you get about things regarding housing resources?

How often is the hub updated, and who maintains it?
Do you have any monetary restraints when it comes to building the hub?
Would you mind having interactive tools such as simulators and mini-games that teach people about the housing process?
Have you ever thought about having AI assistance through virtual assistants to help with site-wide navigation?

Jastiasia Jones
What's one problem you see over and over again when helping first-time homebuyers
How do you currently reach young adults and let them know about the resources available?
What's one idea you've always wanted to try to reach younger residents but haven't had the chance to do yet?

Besides affordability, what do you think young adults are really looking for when deciding where to live?

What do you think makes it difficult for young adults to take the first step toward homeownership?

What's one thing about Newport News that you think young adults completely overlook
What's one assumption people make about affordable housing hub that isn't true?
What types of housing resources or programs do you wish more people knew about?
What are some common questions or concerns you hear from people looking for housing assistance?
What trends have you noticed with younger adults when it comes to renting or wanting to buy a home?
Do you think young adults understand the different grants and assistance programs available to help with buying a home? Why or why not?
What is one thing you think young adults should know before they start looking for a home?
If you could improve one way the Housing Hub connects with younger generations, what would you change?

Team 1 Interview Notes (Q&A):

Information about the Housing Hub - *Hub should be able to make easily accessible solutions to the problem of lack of younger audiences moving/staying in Newport News. Newport News has a lack of attraction due to being a smaller community, however there is an advantage to this because of it being cheaper than popular cities (New York or D.C.).*

Business goal: How can we retain/attract younger generations to live in Newport News?

Information about Facade Improvement Program - *They have the facade improvement program to help improve housing in neighborhoods of their choice. Facade improvement program focuses on the aesthetics of the street/city.*

Question: Is there a certain image/story that you would like to convey for Newport News? - don't ask questions similar to this or the same question. Answer: Their goal is to change prior narratives on the City of Newport News that puts them in a more positive light for first time renters/homeowners.

Question: Trends on social media - attraction and excitement of Newport News, How would this be tied to the housing hub? Answer: How could this be started on social media? Use social media as a tool of advertisement for attractions, for example the park and beach.

Question: Are you open to younger nurses and sailors? (healthcare professionals/military workers) - scrap any questions related to this !! Answer: Perfect timing for the increase of shipyard, military workers, and healthcare professionals because of the development of areas that those demographics can benefit from. Nonetheless, don't forget other folks like college students and parents as target audiences as well.

Team 2 Interview Notes (Q&A):

Question: College Housing, Off-campus? Answer: Difficulty due to being more expensive than on-campus housing. Whether you're forced or not, they want to ensure that anybody that lives in Newport News has a good housing situation (affordable).

Information about Business Partner: *The company is focused on housing within Newport News, but Mr. Grant has worked in housing for the general state of Virginia.*

Question: Problems with credit for buying houses? Answer: If you were to get a loan before buying a house, it can mess up credit which causes you to not be eligible for a housing loan. However, if you get the housing loan first, you could just pay the mortgage and build equity to be able to buy other things. Most common - people aren't aware that other loans can affect credit in relation to being able to afford housing.

Question: Ideas for housing hub? What would you want it to include? Answer: Yes, build a hub to make it truly a one stop shop. Initial discussions were about making this a possible

rehabilitation hub for programs, but why stop there because of the many other situations where people need assistance?

Question: Is it updated? Who is responsible for maintaining it in the future? Answer: Wants it to be as easy as possible to update the website. Needs to be user-friendly for not just the IT department but also the other faculty and staff can add on things as needed.

Question: If the housing hub could take off one thing from your plate, what would it be? Answer: Things that don't involve a lot of thought, then the housing hub can help make it readily available.

Question: How does the city connect with the community, students and military personnel? Answer: Military community is a possible genre for the hub itself for resources, improving housing for personnel at mid to lower ranking levels. How can the city better partner with the military to help military personnel with expanding their options? Setting up events to further connect with the community, for example events happening on September 25th. Realtors Pre-Conference, giving them a tour of the city and even the golf course. This gives opportunities to gain connections and see where they can improve and learn how to attract more newcomers into the community.

General Summary: *Showcasing the lifestyle vs. Showcasing the tool (the hub), the differences between the two and their impact that it could bring on the city. What are some attractive things for the target audience of this project? College students? Military Personnel? Healthcare Workers? Families?*

Question:How are they attracting young buyers? Answer:Making nightlife an important as well as entertainment .

Mr Grant spoke about student housing and having that in Newport news to give students more off campus housing

Question:Would you be open to using newer trends and social media

Answer: Mr Grant spoke on how his team uses the newest trends to keep up with the younger generation and catch their eye and better reach to them.

Question: What's one problem you see happening over and over again when it comes to first time home buyers? Answer: Ma

Question: What upcoming developments could help future housing opportunities

Answer: Mr Grant discussed several projects happening in the city, including the new Navy housing development downtown, the Yard District, Restaurant Row, and other ongoing projects. He expects them to attract more residents and open them up to more housing opportunities.

Question: How important is imagery in the Housing Hub?

Answer: Mr.Grant said that storytelling and visuals would be more effective than just having information up on the hub. People need to see how other people live their lives in Newport News so they can get either an idea or a better understanding of the culture. He suggested using real experiences, community stories, and lifestyle focused videos/pictures to help people see Newport News for what it is before introducing the housing resources.

Question: How should the housing hub be marketed to young people?

Answer: Instead of pushing the idea of the housing hub itself, Mr Grant thinks the City should promote Newport News lifestyle first. Showing local attractions, waterfront activities, restaurants, community events, and affordable homeownership can capture initial attention, then that would naturally lead people to the housing hub.

Social Media/Marketing (How can using social media benefit the housing market? Should it be used to promote? Why or why not?)

Source #1: Social Media Marketing For Real Estate: Key Strategies For Success
Source #2: The Impact of Social Media on Housing Market Trends – HomeSight.org
Source #3: 10 Practical Real Estate Social Media Marketing Strategies (& ideas)

Key Takeaways for Source #1: 43% of homebuyers start their research on the internet. Amongst Gen z and Millennials, 41% used social media to learn about the housing market. Agents mainly focus on facebook, instagram, and linkedin. The tips for success with facebook is strengthening relationships with the community by sharing success stories from clients and community highlights. Instagram has a mostly gen z user base, so it would be important to show listings with Stories and Reels, make sure to make it lifestyle focused. And lastly for Linkedin, it is good to share market insights, milestones and project updates to stay connected with referral partners, peers, and investors. Other tips for Social Media - Property Features, Neighborhood Insights, Client Success Stories, Run Paid Campaigns, and Focus on Building Trust and Credibility.

Key Takeaways for Source #2: Social media has altered how properties are viewed/marketed, agent to client relationships, and helping consumers make informed decisions. It allows for real-time market data, virtual tours, and targeted advertising. Due to consumers being able to access information easily through social media, from property listings, marketing trends, and real estate advice, it is arguably an advantage for the housing market. Although there are pros with using social media for real estate, there are also several cons to its use. The challenges and limitations are the saturation of the market, misinformation, privacy and security concerns, and it only enhances engagement which makes the traditional transactions irreplaceable. With these challenges and limitations, real estate agents/business owners will have to be careful with just relying on social media when it comes to attracting consumers due to misinformation and changes in trends.

Key Takeaways for Source #3: 99% of homebuyers who use the internet in their home buying hunts are between the ages of 24 and 57. The 10 strategies of standing out on social media within the real estate market are initiating a strong brand identity, video marketing, building trust with social proof and UGC content, using hashtags and geo-tagging, scheduled posts, targeted advertisements, interactive content, local influencer partnerships and business collaborations, optimize listings and showcasing properties creatively, and monitoring performance/adapting to new trends. Successful

social media marketing is all about strategic execution, consistency, and engagement in order to gain the right audience.

Sources:

https://www.virginiahousing.com/about/strategic-direction-annual-reports

https://budget.lis.virginia.gov/item/2025/1/HB1600/Chapter/1/102/?utm_source

https://nlihc.org/news/nlihc-releases-gap-2026-shortage-affordable-homes

Virginia Housing Annual Report (FY2024), Virginia continues to invest heavily in making homeownership more accessible for first-time buyers. Through the REACH Virginia initiative, the organization invested more than $17.5 million in first-time homebuyer assistance during fiscal year 2024. Since the program began, Virginia Housing has invested over $915 million in affordable housing, nonprofit housing organizations, rental assistance, and homeownership programs. These investments demonstrate the state's commitment to helping families overcome financial barriers and increase access to safe and affordable housing.

The Commonwealth of Virginia created the First-Time Homebuyer Grant Program to address one of the largest obstacles to homeownership: the high upfront costs of purchasing a home. The program provides eligible first-time homebuyers with grants of up to $10,000, covering as much as 5% of eligible homebuying expenses, including down payments and closing costs. By reducing these financial burdens, the program helps moderate-income families purchase homes sooner and encourages long-term homeownership throughout the state.

The National Low Income Housing Coalition reports that the United States continues to face a severe shortage of affordable housing, with a deficit of approximately 7 million affordable rental homes for extremely low-income households. This shortage has made it increasingly difficult for many families to find affordable housing or save enough money to become homeowners. The organization emphasizes that expanding affordable housing programs, increasing down payment assistance, and investing in housing development are critical steps toward improving housing stability and creating more opportunities for first-time homebuyers across the country.

What programs/housing hub resources are helping other communities that Newport News should look at adopting?

PRHA Scholarships

Key Takeaways:

Portsmouth has scholarship opportunities for SCHA for participants living 6 months+ in Housing Choice Voucher areas.

How active BP and the city is with the community, Military and local activities.

Source: https://www.facebook.com/events/100-museum-dr-newport-news-va-united-states-virginia-23606/uss-indianola/3194339037622479/
Source: https://www.eventbrite.com/e/the-shipyard-experience-a-trolley-and-walking-tour-tickets-1991206724916?aff=ebdiglgoogleliveevents
Source: https://www.suffolknewsherald.com/sponsored-content/all-about-moving-to-newport-news-va-what-should-you-know-before-moving-there-6178f769

Newport News has three different active events scheduled next month that involve the military and the naval shipyard. Looking at the Facebook post for the USS Indianola event, there are only 12 people that liked the post and the PCB free concert only has 14 likes. Newport News posted 256 events on EventBrite, but only had 167 followers on the platform.

An article from the Suffolk News Herald states that areas like Hilton Village and PortWarwick are considered safe and have active community engagement. City center is also a great spot for young people to settle for a nightlife lifestyle with the local business around.

KeyTakeaway: It appears that Newport News is in fact very active when it comes to connecting with the military and local businesses. The problem is that they do not advertise as they should and the city's social media pages are getting little to no traffic

even from its own citizens. From what is stated in the Suffolk news article, there are specific areas that are considered safe opposed to what is misrepresented by the city as a whole and there is the city center that is great for young people to even live the night life.

Key Insights

Christiney: Newport News connects with their community, but does not have enough exposure.

Christiney: The city of Newport News has a lot of misrepresentation that causes people to not want to move there, but the city does not advertise safe cities and the city center to counter misrepresentation. *(Where are the safer cities? Is there housing in these areas?) (Are there plans to improve the "rougher" neighborhoods? If so, what are they?)*

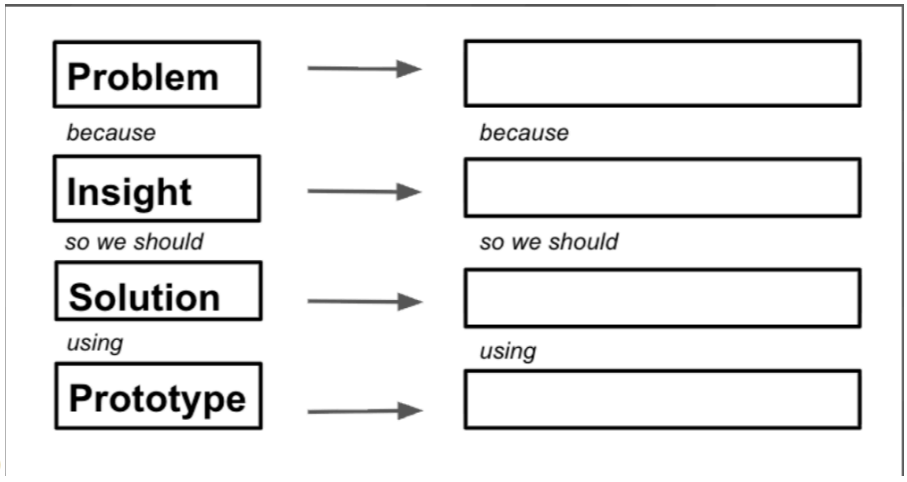
Jastiasia/Other cities are interacting more with citizens than Newport News when it comes to program exposure and expansion.*What do other Newport's new cities offer that Hampton road cites do not? Based on my research many people know Virginia Beach for their ocean front and Norfolk for their downtown and arts, but Newport News does not seem to have a storing identity many young adults know of. Why do I think that is?*

Andy: Newport News lacks innovation and is behind in modern social media interactions. *(possibly can be related/due to the lack of program exposure and the misrepresentation within Newport News)* (The city needs to push their tech team to hire individuals who are familiar with modern social media techniques) *(Gen Z and Millennials are the audience you want to target, in the direction social media is taking…What do you think would be innovative for your social media success?) (Expanding on modern social media interactions, what ways would adding virtual tours or more interactive posts for consumers online help with the Newport News real estate market?) (How different is the social media department or marketing for Newport News compared to others within the Hampton Roads areas?) (What evidence contradicts the success of social media with the housing market?) (How can those issues be addressed and transformed?)*

Cat: Advertising contingency plans that will reassure first time home buyers and help with worries.

We noticed that a lot of communities offer programs for specific groups, like first time homebuyers, veterans, seniors, or low income families. *(Are there any groups you think still need more support or resources when it comes to housing in Newport news?, what is your budget for the housing hub in regard to the actual website?How do most residents find out about housing resources?)*

What about jobs and schools?


Problem
because
Insight
so we should
Solution
using
Prototype
because
so we should
using

Key Insight Ideas and Solutions

1. The Housing Hub should be a one-stop resource
2. Community investment extends beyond housing
3.

Andy:

1. Promotion of Downtown Development for arts and residential areas (solution to Newport News' problem of attracting the intended audience for the project) on social sites.
2. Allow for more access to virtual housing information for first time homebuyers.
3. Hiring more people to help with social media marketing or get the city to help fund it

Christiney:

1. Safety is what most people look for when moving to a new area.
2. Have more resources like blue light phones throughout neighbourhoods.
3. Increase traffic on social media to connect with community in NN three regions
4. Host events to raise exposure in safer neighbourhoods and areas that young people will be comfortable raising a family or live the night lifestyle.

Key Insights Interview Questions

Interview Questions
Digging/Follow-up Questions:

- Can you give me an example?
- Can you say more about that?
- How did that make you feel?
- Why?

Best Practices:

1. **All:** Introduce yourself and thank your business partner for coming
2. **One person:** Start (on time) by asking your first question, Pick an easy one to get them started.
3. **Share note taking:** Have a plan for who will be taking notes**.** Divide this responsibility up so that you all have a chance to ask questions.
4. **All:** Close (on time) by thanking your business partner for the opportunity.
5. **Tip: "**You are presenting even when you're not presenting." - *Leticia Tuset, Teamship Alumna.*
6. *Try not to ask questions you can easily find on the internet. (avoid shut down questions yes/no) keep it openended.*

Interview plan:
1. Christiney
2. Cat (intro)(outro)
3. Andy
4. Jastasia

Possible Intro

"Good evening, Mr. Grant! My name is Jastasia, and I'll be leading us through today's interview. First off, we just want to thank you for taking the time to meet with us, we really appreciate you being here.
Make sure to introduce yourself, the college you're representing, and ask your business partner how he is doing!!

Reminders:
Take notes (make sure to keep phones on silent)
We have roughly 6.5-7.5 mins each, set a timer on your device to ensure we are all on track with the interview for the sake of ourselves and the other team.

Transition phrase:

"Now that I've discussed ___, I'll turn it over to [Andy], who will take a deeper look into the city's use of social media."

"To build on these findings, I'll turn it over to [Jastasia], to discuss more about Newport News' housing programs__."

"I'll now hand it over to [cat] who will discuss

Christiney:

1. What do you think are the top three factors people consider when living in Newport News? And how does the housing department address them?

2. What do you believe are the biggest factors contributing to Newport News receiving less attention from potential and current residents?

3. What has Newport News done to counter the misconceptions that it is unsafe there and that the city lacks any form of entertainment?

4. We found in our research that Newport News is graded D for crime rates. How has the housing division in Newport News connected with other departments in the city for housing in areas known to have higher crime rates?

Andy:

For the audience you want to target, we have noticed a lack of social media presence and innovation on the facebook account for the Housing department. Who exactly is in charge of social media? (New Department) What are the strategies that the team performs? If there is an IT/social media staff, if so then are they updated on the latest trends and collaborate with local celebrities or well-known people?

Expanding on research, do you think if the social media team were to implement more interactive posts and virtual property tours/listings, that it could increase success for the business? Could you say more about this?

How different is the social media department or marketing for Newport News compared to others within the Hampton Roads areas? Can you give an example of this?

Branding/Marketing

Negativity on Social media (Governments, Locally)

Jastiasia-

What do you think Newport News offers that sets it apart from other Hampton Roads cities?

Based on my research, many people know Virginia Beach for its oceanfront and Norfolk for their downtown and arts, but Newport News does not seem to have one strong identity many young adults know of. Why do you think that is?

How do you measure whether the housing hub is successfully reaching and engaging in the community?

How many staff members are responsible for managing and maintaining the housing hub?

Cat:
Our first question is: "Since the Innovation Team is now working with you on the Housing Hub, have you all started brainstorming any ideas or priorities for the project yet?" (side note it would have been amazing to talk to the innovation team as well)

Thank you for sharing that. Our last question is: When it comes to improving the Housing Hub, what kinds of resources or limitations do you have to consider, such as funding, staffing, or technology?

Before we end our interview, do you have any comments for us?

Andy's Notes for Key Insights Interview:

New Innovation Team, but due to the nature of politics there isn't any public announcement of this information.

Notes for Christiney's Questions: The top three factors when considering moving to Newport News are the type of housing for self/family available and obtainable (low supply, high demand issue), schools (varies depending on person's life stage), and crime (Office of Community Safety, Office of Neighborhood Services). The mayor of Newport News recently reported the lowest murder rate in quite some time. A lot of the work takes place in Southeast Newport News, which is the historically oldest part in Newport News. Heavy investment within the community, for example creating new housing and infrastructure for families and people living in the projects. Temporary housing relocation, not everyone was able to move back into the improved community. PEEK (or PEAK) organization and New Workforce Center.

Notes for Jastiasia's Questions: For a variety of reasons, for example Virginia Beach has a bigger population and is the most known city for people who have lived outside of Virginia. Newport News has small beaches, parks, and museums. Ella Fitzgerald and Late Pearl Ellen (might've spelled her name wrong). Virginia Beach has a lot more entertainment and small business attractions for younger people. Newport News is developing their downtown as more of a residential and arts area. Data lags (is a bit behind), even since last year, the interest in development for Newport News has skyrocketed to the point where they are running out of land to have space for developments.

Notes for Cat's Questions: Expanding on the Innovation Team's work, from surveys and interviews, not enough people have the income to pursue renovations or other related projects as far as housing. The median age for houses are houses made in the 1970s. People have a lack of information about potential resources to help them financially. Hub was created as a way to address these issues. They are not worried about the budget because their new team has a disposable income for funding projects/building something digital (the hub), the city also has funding. There are some potential constraints with what designs the hub could look like, the city is changing everything so websites would possibly be limited based on what the city wants.

Notes from Team 1: The Housing Emporium would discuss issues with the city, including housing. The Facade Program is only for exterior improvements, but there is also a downpayment program. Neighborhood Grant Program, great way for the community to come together to help improve the neighborhood from the city's funding. As department and funding grows, they will put more programs/funding opportunities out there. Rebuilding Together (National Profit), helps elderly residents with a fixed (lower) income. The Redevelopment Housing Authority is a separate authority from Housing and Neighborhood Services. Has a guideline for their downpayment program, but it will be fixed up to meet qualifications and get to a point where they could innovate. The southeast community is a top target, but there are a total of three districts. Three districts are North, Central, and South. All parts of the city have an aging housing stock. However, North and Central have a lot more newer housing in place. Newport

News Now (Digital News Mailing Letter) To narrow the audience of the housing hub, there were talks with teamship to focus on just how the housing hub could try to connect more with a younger audience. Investing Heavily in branding for example, logos to give a fresh new look for the City of Newport News. Neighborhood Prosperity Tool, how can we improve? Combat negativity with positivity.

Notes from Andy's questions:
NN has a new department for social media and it is not fully flushed out yet. They have a good communications team, but they do not have great marketing yet. The team is small so it may take some time for the city's social media to progress.

The front porch is now social media. NN is trying to meet people where they are. Mr.Grant sees that social media is negative and believes that good intentions turn awry due to miscommunication and misinformation. Someone created a social media page to harass NN employees for clout. This harms the city and they have gotten negative reactions from people on their social media pages.

Notes from Jastasia's questions:
People from NY travel to Hampton roads regularly, but most people still don't know much about the city itself. He says that the city should celebrate their celebs and historical figures more. Does Newport News still host the annual Ella Fitzgerald Music Festival?
The city should celebrate local business and have a more upbeat downtown similar to Norfolk and VB. Wants to focus on making downtown an arts and culture area.
Not enough data to know if new childcare programs are actually increasing the amount of people, but the interest in development has skyrocketed faster than what the city can handle. PEAKE is a decades old childcare center.

Notes for Cat's questions:
NN IT team has shifted focus on the hub, but is mostly worrying about content and needs atm. People do not have enough disposable income to pursue house renovations for decades old houses. Houses and neighborhoods are falling apart due to age and many of the people in this situation do not know that there are resources available to help with this.

He has been told to not worry about the budget and the IT team even has their own funding. Constraints with what the design will look like because they want the websites to be consistent. He does not know how limited these constraints will make the hub.

Team 1 Notes:

What are some of the most important resources that a new homeowner should know about?

The facade program for exterior improvements for homes is available for anyone. Some pushback on this program due to the lack of min and max income limits. Neighbourhood grant program to get project proposals for the city to fix the whole neighbourhood.
The hub will provide information about classes that might interest users and to boost engagement, ex: seminars. Religious institutions have the innate right to build on their property without needing permission from the city. Rebuilding together is a program for low income elders to fix their houses. The portal could identify the age range or what the person is looking for and send them to a new page that will give them personalized information (algorithm?)

The Housing Authority website may inspire the hub (content not design). A house is the number one wealth building tool in the US, how can we get people to attain this?

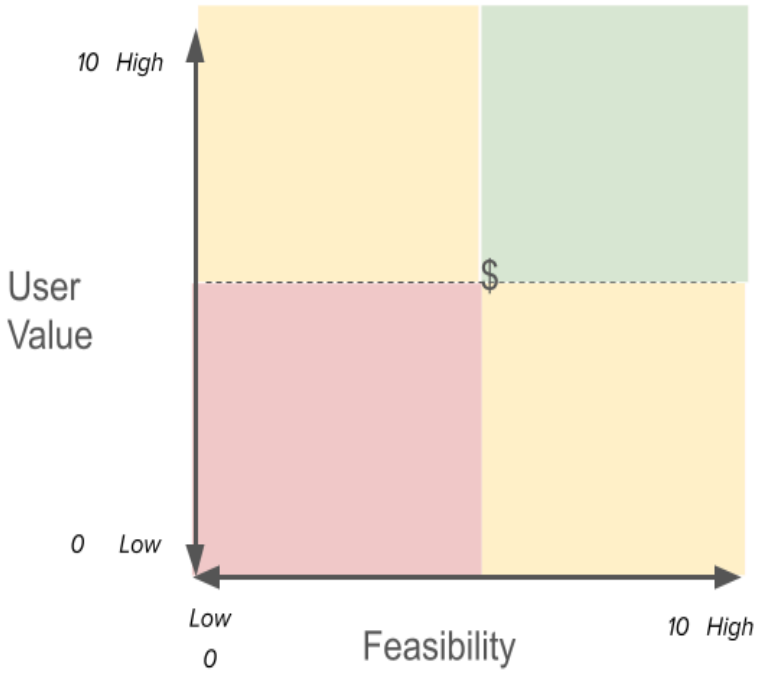
The areas they want to target: Central and north regions have the newest houses, Huntington point is a new housing area. Focus on the three regions and connect with the community and develop more houses. The most effective approach is using digital social media (Newport News Now newsletter). (*Encourage people to register for the digital newsletter)

What would narrowing down the audience look like? He does not really want to narrow down everyone going to the hub, he wants to focus on having more younger people join the hub specifically.

There are no ads for the housing authority or they are very limited.

What measures are there to counter bad news? Neighbourhood disparity tool to determine what aspects of that area will be made public and will be worked on.

Decision Matrix



	Low Feasibility	Mid Feasibility	High Feasibility
High User Value	A4, C2, Retention and recruitment	A2, A3, CG1, CG4, J4, C1, hub improvements	A1,A5, CG2, CG3, CG5, J1, J2, J3, C3, C4, Social media strategy
Mid User Value		CG6, CG7	financial resources
Low User Value			

Feasibility is how possible it is to do a project, and value is how much benefit or worth the project brings

Andy's solutions (Social Media & Marketing):

1. Posting positive things done for community, for instance promotion of the new developments and improvements within the southern district of Newport News, limiting misinformation/misrepresentation of Newport News (negativity, misinformation, and misrepresentation due to hate accounts or lack of credible sources online) $ HVHF
2. Allow for more access to virtual housing information for first time homebuyers (give virtual tours for example) ! % HVMF
3. Hiring more people to help with social media marketing or get the city to help fund it HVMF
4. Branding (innovation) HVLF
5. Create accounts on platforms like Instagram or Tiktok to gain newer audiences through the latest trends (behind on modern social media) $ @ % HVHF

Cat's solutions (hub features):

1. Mr. Grant mentioned that "people don't know where to start" so having a Homepage Search & Quick Nav Bar will make it easy for residents to find information @ % HVHF
2. Making a Find a Home tab can centralize the buying, renting, and building resources into one location HVHF
3. Add a Plan & Learn section with a step-by-step for first-time homebuyers so they can get a better understanding of the homebuying process. % !$ HVHF
4. Add community investments and redevelopment projects that Mr. Grant told us about which would get more contractors interested and more potential residents to see that there are current efforts in improving the QOL in Newport News. HVMF
5. Add resources for people who need emergency assistance, repairs, maintenance lists, or maybe even programs that help those who can't do maintenance on their own home anymore (disabled, estranged spouses, etc) %!$ HVHF
6. Add a meet the team section so that potential residents, contractors, etc can know who to contact for everything MVMF
7. Include the newsletter and community updates probably under the events tab so people see the changes happening throughout Newport News and the events. MVMF

Jastiasia solutions:

1.The Housing Hub should be a one-stop resource @ % HVHF

2.Community investment extends beyond housing HVHF

3. Many first time home buyers aren't financially ready or prepared so a good solution could be having a workshop curriculum(budgeting tool kit) or an online learning portal with a check list and calculators.! $ % HVHF

4. People want to compare neighborhoods before moving,we could have a dashboard comparing neighborhoods by affordability,schools,crime, transportation and amities. HVMF

Christiney's Solutions (Community & Lifestyle):

1. Safety is what most people look for when moving to a new area (Show that NN does in fact have safe neighbourhoods and areas to work). $ HVMF
2. Have more resources for safety like blue light phones throughout neighbourhoods. HVLF
3. Increase traffic on social media to connect with communities in the three regions that NN is focusing on (Do more physical ground work to raise awareness such as: send info brochures in the mail, give out flyers at events,libraries, rec centers, etc., have simple ads with QR codes that link to hub and other digital resources). $! % HVHF
4. Host events to raise exposure in safer neighbourhoods and areas that young people will be comfortable raising a family or live the night lifestyle. @ HVHF

JPrototype Ideas

Andy: Social media simulation

Cat: Housing hub simulation

Jastasia: PDF of programs

Christiney: Calendar, simulation of safety resources with information like phone numbers, people, programs, and areas that are getting help, simulation for community and lifestyle.

` Condensed Category Summary For Interview Notes

Category	Main Focus
1. Attracting and Retaining Younger Residents	Making Newport News more appealing to younger generations
2. Target Audiences and Community Segments	Students, families, military personnel, healthcare workers, newcomers, renters, and buyers
3. Housing Affordability and Education	Credit, loans, mortgages, affordability, and first-time homebuyer challenges
4. Housing Hub as a One-Stop Resource	Centralizing housing programs, resources, and assistance
5. Website Usability and Maintenance	Making the platform easy for City staff to update and maintain
6. Marketing, Storytelling, and Development	Promoting the Newport News lifestyle and using visuals, social media, and development to attract residents

Social Media/Marketing (How can using social media benefit the housing market? Should it be used to promote? Why or why not?)

Source #1: Social Media Marketing For Real Estate: Key Strategies For Success
Source #2: The Impact of Social Media on Housing Market Trends – HomeSight.org
Source #3: 10 Practical Real Estate Social Media Marketing Strategies (& ideas)

Key Takeaways for Source #1: 43% of homebuyers start their research on the internet. Amongst Gen z and Millennials, 41% used social media to learn about the housing market. Agents mainly focus on facebook, instagram, and linkedin. The tips for success with facebook is strengthening relationships with the community by sharing success stories from clients and community highlights. Instagram has a mostly gen z user base, so it would be important to show listings with Stories and Reels, make sure to make it lifestyle focused. And lastly for Linkedin, it is good to share market insights, milestones and project updates to stay connected with referral partners, peers, and investors. Other tips for Social Media - Property Features, Neighborhood Insights, Client Success Stories, Run Paid Campaigns, and Focus on Building Trust and Credibility.

Key Takeaways for Source #2: Social media has altered how properties are viewed/marketed, agent to client relationships, and helping consumers make informed decisions. It allows for real-time market data, virtual tours, and targeted advertising. Due to consumers being able to access information easily through social media, from property listings, marketing trends, and real estate advice, it is arguably an advantage for the housing market. Although there are pros with using social media for real estate, there are also several cons to its use. The challenges and limitations are the saturation of the market, misinformation, privacy and security concerns, and it only enhances engagement which makes the traditional transactions irreplaceable. With these challenges and limitations, real estate agents/business owners will have to be careful with just relying on social media when it comes to attracting consumers due to misinformation and changes in trends.

Key Takeaways for Source #3: 99% of homebuyers who use the internet in their home buying hunts are between the ages of 24 and 57. The 10 strategies of standing out on social media within the real estate market are initiating a strong brand identity, video marketing, building trust with social proof and UGC content, using hashtags and geo-tagging, scheduled posts, targeted advertisements, interactive content, local influencer partnerships and business collaborations, optimize listings and showcasing properties creatively, and monitoring performance/adapting to new trends. Successful

social media marketing is all about strategic execution, consistency, and engagement in order to gain the right audience.

1. Sources:
   https://www.virginiahousing.com/about/strategic-direction-annual-reports

   https://budget.lis.virginia.gov/item/2025/1/HB1600/Chapter/1/102/?utm_source

   https://nlihc.org/news/nlihc-releases-gap-2026-shortage-affordable-homes

   Virginia Housing Annual Report (FY2024), Virginia continues to invest heavily in making homeownership more accessible for first-time buyers. Through the REACH Virginia initiative, the organization invested more than $17.5 million in first-time homebuyer assistance during fiscal year 2024. Since the program began, Virginia Housing has invested over $915 million in affordable housing, nonprofit housing organizations, rental assistance, and homeownership programs. These investments demonstrate the state's commitment to helping families overcome financial barriers and increase access to safe and affordable housing.

   The Commonwealth of Virginia created the First-Time Homebuyer Grant Program to address one of the largest obstacles to homeownership: the high upfront costs of purchasing a home. The program provides eligible first-time homebuyers with grants of up to $10,000, covering as much as 5% of eligible homebuying expenses, including down payments and closing costs. By reducing these financial burdens, the program helps moderate-income families purchase homes sooner and encourages long-term homeownership throughout the state.

   The National Low Income Housing Coalition reports that the United States continues to face a severe shortage of affordable housing, with a deficit of approximately 7 million affordable rental homes for extremely low-income households. This shortage has made it increasingly difficult for many families to find affordable housing or save enough money to become homeowners. The organization emphasizes that expanding affordable housing programs, increasing down payment assistance, and investing in housing development are critical steps toward improving housing stability and creating more opportunities for first-time homebuyers across the country.

What programs/housing hub resources are helping other communities that Newport News should look at adopting?

PRHA Scholarships
Housing Resources | City of Virginia Beach
Home - City of Charlotte

Key Takeaways:

Portsmouth has scholarship opportunities for SCHA for participants living 6 months+ in Housing Choice Voucher areas.

One of the biggest takeaways from the research is that many other housing hubs provide housing resources beyond just buying a home. For example, I found that Virginia Beach has a comprehensive housing resource guide that includes info on foreclosure prevention, rental assistance, apartment resources, homelessness services, and emergency housing support. Having all of these resources available in one place makes it much easier for younger and older residents to find what they are looking for, and young people seem to be afraid of the housing market due to all of the swindling and mishaps that happen, so having contingency programs like these gives them that cushion in their mind.

Another important finding was that many communities offer financial assistance programs. For example, Portsmouth offers scholarship opportunities for income-eligible residents to help remove financial barriers to homeownership and housing education. Programs like these encourage more people to participate and make homeownership feel more achievable and put off the stereotype of some housing areas.

Our research also showed that many hubs focus on prevention by making programs for housing issues before they become larger problems. For example, North Carolina's Lead-Based Paint Hazard Reduction Program helps low-income families identify and remove lead hazards from older homes. Including information about health, home safety, and home repair assistance alongside traditional housing resources.

How active BP and the city is with the community, Military and local activities.

Source:
https://www.facebook.com/events/100-museum-dr-newport-news-va-united-states-virginia-23606/uss-indianola/3194339037622479/
Source:
https://www.eventbrite.com/e/the-shipyard-experience-a-trolley-and-walking-tour-tickets-1991206724916?aff=ebdiglgoogleliveevents
Source:
https://www.suffolknewsherald.com/sponsored-content/all-about-moving-to-newport-news-va-what-should-you-know-before-moving-there-6178f769

Newport News has three different active events scheduled next month that involve the military and the naval shipyard. Looking at the Facebook post for the USS Indianola event, there are only 12 people that liked the post and the PCB free concert only has 14 likes. Newport News posted 256 events on EventBrite, but only had 167 followers on the platform.

An article from the Suffolk News Herald states that areas like Hilton Village and PortWarwick are considered safe and have active community engagement. City center is also a great spot for young people to settle for a nightlife lifestyle with the local business around.

KeyTakeaway: It appears that Newport News is in fact very active when it comes to connecting with the military and local businesses. The problem is that they do not advertise as they should and the city's social media pages are getting little to no traffic even from its own citizens. From what is stated in the Suffolk news article, there are specific areas that are considered safe opposed to what is misrepresented by the city as a whole and there is the city center that is great for young people to even live the night life.

Slide 1 - Title (Andy)

Newport News Housing Hub/ Attracting people to the Newport News Housing Hub.

(~30 seconds)

Good afternoon Mr. Grant, and thank you for taking the time to meet with us today.

My name is Andy, and alongside are Cat (pause), Christiney (pause), and Jastashia (pause), and we're Team 2.

Throughout the past several weeks, we've researched how Newport News can better attract residents to its housing resources. We combined our own research with the insights you shared during our interview, and today we'd like to walk you through the solution we created.

“Next slide please.”

Slide 2 Meeting Agenda (Christiney)-

(~20 seconds)

Today we'll walk through our project in six parts.

(point)

First, we'll discuss the business problem.

Then our key insight.

The research that led us there.

Our proposed solution.

The deliverables each team member created.

And finally, we'll end with a live demonstration of our Housing Hub prototype.

Next slide please.

Slide 3 - The Business problem (Cat)

Problem : “Many Newport News residents, especially younger adults and first time homebuyers, don’t know where to begin when searching for housing resources, while the city also struggles to communicate the positive changes happening throughout Newport News.

(~1 minute)

During our research and our interview with you, one theme kept coming up.

Newport News already has housing programs.

It already has redevelopment projects, such as the fascade program you shared.

It already has financial assistance.

But many residents simply don't know those resources exist.

(point)

First-time homebuyers don't know where to begin.

Younger residents aren't being reached through the city's current communication methods.

And because of that, many of the positive things happening throughout Newport News go unnoticed.

The challenge is making sure people actually find the resources.

Next slide please.

Slide 4 - Key Insight (Jastiasia)

(~45 sec)

From that, we identified one key insight.

Residents need one trusted place where they can find everything related to housing instead of searching across multiple websites and departments.

(point)

During our interview, Mr. Grant said that:

"People don't know what they don't know."

That became the foundation for our entire project.

So instead of creating another resource...

...we wanted to create one central starting point.

Next slide please.

Slide 5 Research (Jastiasia)-

(~1 minute)

To make sure our solution addressed multiple perspectives, we researched multiple different areas.

(point)

We researched

community safety, quality of life, and neighborhood engagement.

marketing, branding, and modern social media outreach.

financial readiness and first-time homebuyer education and

website usability.

After combining our research with the feedback from Mr. Grant, we identified what our Housing Hub needed to include.

Next slide please.

Slide 6 - Our solution (Andy)

(~1 minute)

Our solution is keeping people on the Newport News Housing Hub.

Rather than sending residents to multiple websites, departments, and programs…

Our goal is not to draw younger people to the housing hub, it is to make them stay.

Everything starts here.

(point)

Navigation

Financial tools

Community resources

Education

Social media integration

Each piece supports the others, creating one simple starting point for residents no matter where they are in the homebuying journey.

We also created several supporting deliverables to complement the website.

“Next Slide Please”

Slide 7 Meeting Emily (Cat) -

“This is Emily.
She's 23 years old and just graduated from Christopher Newport University. She recently accepted her first full-time job as a Registered Nurse at Riverside Regional Medical Center here in Newport News."

"Emily earns about $4,200 per month before taxes and currently pays $1,500 a month in rent for an apartment. She's ready to stop renting and start looking into buying her first home, but she has no idea where to begin..

Slide 8 - Andy Social Media

(Present Social Media Project)
Just like Emily, many young residents will look at social media as a source for housing information and to guide them into buying/renting a home.
Although they already have a Facebook account, it does not have a lot of engaging content. So our focus for a piece of the solution was to come up with ways that they could modernize their social media.

The steps they should take to improve their social media are sharing positive community updates and new developments. Highlight housing programs, workshops, and success stories. Lastly, Use short for videos, Reels, and trending content to reach younger audiences.

Next Slide Please

Slide 9 Christiney Calendar -

How can the city focus on community engagement initiatives?
This is our prototype schedule to help the city structure community engagement around any event.

There are four phases for this framework, The first week is awareness - coordinate with the event host and post on all social media websites ASAP.

The second is momentum - invest in physical outreach like flyers, but remember to stay active on all social media platforms because consistency is key when it comes to social media.

Third week is conversion - adjust for any changes and ask the host about any potential cancellations (weather, low ticket sale, etc.)

Fourth week is execution - Final last call reminders on social media and a clear plan for handling disruptions for city hosted events.

Next Slide Please

Slide 10 Jastiasia Financial Affordability Calculator -

(Present Calculator)

As a team, we found that empowering buyers starts with making financial education and resources more accessible. Through our research, we saw the importance of helping potential homebuyers understand the true costs of homeownership and prepare for the entire mortgage process.

That's why we came up with the idea of a digital dashboard with interactive financial literacy tools. It could help buyers better understand their finances, plan ahead, and feel more prepared before starting the homebuying process.

Buyers could access these resources through the Newport News hub

"Next Slide Please"

Slide 11 - Cat Prototype demo

> Thank you.
>
> While each of those deliverables can stand on their own, we wanted to show how they all come together into one prototype.

> **"Let's check back in with Emily for a second. She's our 23-year-old first-time homebuyer who's ready to stop renting, but still isn't sure where to start. Let's see how she uses the Housing Hub."**

(Switch tabs.)

(Give me one moment while I switch tabs)

Homepage

- Emily doesn't know where to begin, chicken navigate to the navigation Tab and see the
-
    - Buy
    - Rent

- Build
- Search
- Quick navigation
- Get Started

"Right away, Emily has a clear starting point instead of wondering which website or department to visit."

AI Assistant

- Emily still has questions. So she types in the AI assistant.
-
    - *"I'm a first-time homebuyer. Where should I start?"*
- AI points her to the correct resources.

Journey

- Now Emily wants someone to guide her.
- Mr. Grant said:
    - "People don't know what they don't know."
- This Housing Journey gives her a roadmap.

Buy

- Emily is now ready to explore buying.
- Homeownership programs.
- Financing.
- Counseling.
- Assistance.

Mini Game

- Emily thanks to ourself that she learns better by doing
- So that's exactly what she does with our Interactive challenges.

Build

- Maybe Emily decides she'd rather build one day.
- She can see the general steps it takes to build a property from the ground up and she can also do a interactive mini game

Rent

- Buying isn't her only option so Emily looks into renting in the Newport News area she can find:
- Affordable rentals.
- Rental assistance.
- Resources for renters.

Simulator

- Emily still wants to understand the process so we made a simulator game that she can play to understand the home buyer process more.

Affordability Calculator

- Emily eventually stops and asks herself, wait,:
    - **"Can I actually afford a home?"**
- With the affordability calculators she can Enter income.
- Estimate monthly payment.
- Mention:
    - "This connects directly to Jastashia's financial readiness research."

Neighborhoods

- Emily wants to figure out what neighborhood she may want to live in so she goes to the neighborhood tab and finds
- Schools.
- Affordability.
- Transportation.
- Amenities.

Why Newport News

- Emily wants to know more about what Newport News has to offer so she goes to the y Newport News Tab and finds:

Events

- Emily wants to know about any events that are happening in Newport News so she goes to the events Tab and finds:
- Workshops.
- Community events.
- Newsletters.
- Mention Christiney's outreach ideas.

Contact

- Emily still has questions and navigate to the contact tab of the website to find ways for emergency contact, to contact Newport News office and also to request a housing counselor. She doesn't have to guess when and where.

Pause.

In just a few minutes, Emily went from not knowing where to start to understanding her housing options, estimating her budget, comparing neighborhoods, learning through interactive activities, connecting with community resources, and finding the right people to contact.That's the experience we as team 2, wanted every future Newport News resident to have.

“Next slide please”

Slide 12 - Closing and go back over the agenda (Christiney)

Throughout today's presentation, we walked through

Problem.

Insight.

Research.

Solution.

Deliverables.

Prototype.

(point)

> Together, these pieces create one central resource that makes housing information easier to discover, easier to understand, and easier to access.
>
> We believe this approach can help first-time homebuyers, attract future residents, and better showcase everything Newport News already has to offer.

Next Slide Please

Slide 13- Questions, comments, or concerns (Christiney)

> Thank you again for your time.
>
> We'd be happy to answer any questions, hear your feedback, or discuss ideas for how this concept could continue to grow.